

Figure 1: Windows-VB2

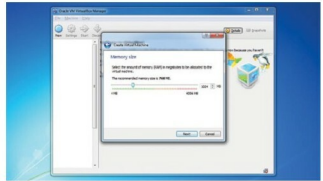


Figure 3: VM-creation3

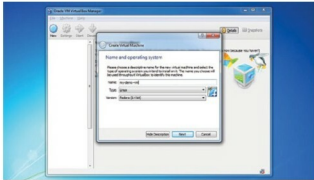


Figure 2: VM-creation2

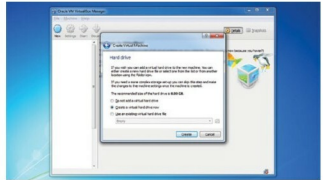


Figure 4: VM-creation4

VBox Python: This module will enable Python support to VMs.

Steps for creating your first VM using VirtualBox

Now that we have VirtualBox installed on our system, let's try and create a VM using it. Since VirtualBox is a platform-independent application, the user interface remains the same across all platforms – Windows, Linux or iOS.

The steps to create and configure a VM using VirtualBox follow. Start the VirtualBox application from the *Start* menu. You will see a welcome screen with the menu option *New*.

Click on *New* to start a new VM creation process.

1. In the next screen (Figure 2), the user will be asked to give a name, select the VM type (Windows, Linux, iOS, etc) and inform what flavour of the selected type is to be installed. For example, I have chosen Linux as my VM type and Fedora-64 bit as my flavour. I also named my VM as *my-demo-vm*.
2. Once done with the above selection, click *Next*. The next screen (Figure 3) will ask you to select how much memory you want to dedicate to your VM. The dialogue box will show a range from a minimum permitted memory range to the maximum physical memory you have on the system. I have chosen 1024MB (1GB) for my demo VM.
3. Click *Next* and the next dialogue box (Figure 4) will ask how much of disk space you want to allocate to the VM. The dialogue box will give you a few options with regard

to disk selection:

- a. **Do not add a virtual hard drive:** This is in case you do not want to have any local storage to your VM. Then where should we install this? Let's leave this option for now.
 - b. **Create a virtual hard drive now:** This is the default selected option and most common too.
 - c. **Use an existing virtual hard drive:** This option is useful when you've already created a VM disk earlier and you want to re-use it.
- For our example, let's go with option 'b', the default, and click on *Create*.
4. The next dialogue box (Figure 5) will show a list of the types of disk drive images that the user can create. Each adds a specific feature but for a normal user, we can go with the default option again and click *Next*.
 5. The next dialogue box (Figure 6) is very important with regard to hard disk drive configuration. Here, the user will have two options to choose from for hard disk space. Let's look at each of them:
 - d. **Dynamically allocated:** This option will create a disk of the minimum required size and then will keep increasing it as needed, up to the maximum disk size limit allocated; but once increased, the reverse doesn't happen.
 - e. **Fixed size:** This option will create the virtual disk drive of the maximum size and the same disk space will be isolated from the host's use.